

Data quality standards: It should define rigorous data quality checking, including accuracy, consistency, completeness, and reliability. It may also define data cleansing and validation practices.

Data security and privacy guidelines: The policy should outline how the organisation will protect sensitive information against security breach incidents and unauthorised use. This includes data encryption, data anonymization, and data access control requirements.

Adherence to regulatory standards: It must include compliance obligations under laws such as GDPR, Consumer Privacy Act (CPA), etc. All regulatory updates must be covered under the policy.

Evaluation and examination

procedures: The policy must have provisions for carrying out regular audits and reviews to ascertain compliance and determine the effectiveness of existing practices.

Procedure for policy violations:

It must detail the sanctions for any violations, ranging from retraining and warnings to dismissal, and even prosecution in extreme cases.

Steps for making a data governance policy

Vision and goal setting: A clear strategy and vision are required to implement data governance, as data is a strategic asset of an organisation.

Governance council (GC): A data governance council should be formed to ensure the implementation of the policy. The size of the council should be large enough for diversity and small enough for effective discussion making. It should include individuals with financial, legal, and industry-specific skills. Independent members who have vast experience in data management can add to the strength of the council.

Policy definition and objectives: The policy definition and objective preamble should state the purpose of the policy and its aim. It should state the scope of

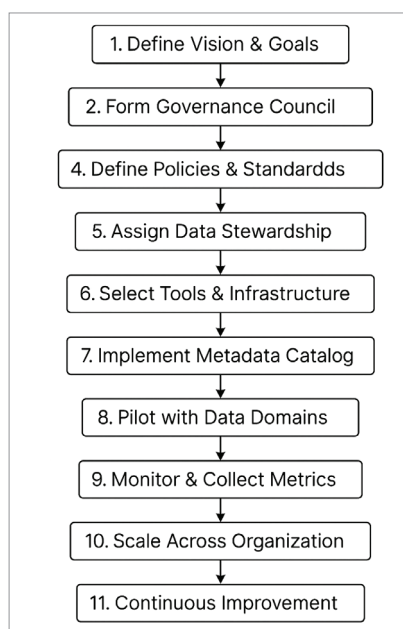


Figure 3: Workflow of a data governance policy

Components of a data governance policy document

1. Title: e.g., Data Security Policy v1.0
2. Purpose and scope
3. Roles and accountability
4. Definitions: Key terms, vocabulary, and classification tiers
5. Policy directives: Controls for each area (e.g., encryption, access, retention, different stakeholders' data authorisation policies)
6. Implementation procedures and standards: Step-by-step enforcement
7. Audit and monitoring: Monitoring and upgrading process
8. Risk and exceptions handling
9. Review policy
10. Glossary and references

the DG, clearly mentioning the type of data, systems, and the departments and geographic regions included. This policy definition should match the stated goal of data governance and comply with

regulations like GDPR, CPA, and HIPR.

The council should classify data into the public, internal, confidential, and restricted classes, and specify data handling procedures. It should also define the authentication methods and data access privileges for stakeholders. Data security and quality should be ensured with proper encryption, masking, tokenization, and anonymization.

A data retention and disposal policy is also important for data governance. It deals with retention periods per data classification and legal/regulatory mandates. It also automates archiving and deletion processes beyond retention thresholds.

Monitoring: Data governance requires periodic audit and maintenance of all the stored data for access, changes, and deletions. Audits are essential for risk monitoring and exception handling.

The GC must review policies and their implementation at least once a year or when new regulations come into force. It may also review the policy adherence rate, audit findings, and incident count.

Training and awareness: The success of data governance requires regular training on policies and procedures. This enables data owners and stewards to learn about the changed rules/regulations and standards.

Data governance is ultimately about using data as a competitive differentiator; it positions data as a strategic advantage. It's not just about safeguarding assets; mission-critical compliance is supported, stakeholder confidence is increased, and raw data is transformed into trustworthy insights with the aid of effective governance. However, it takes constant labour to implement and maintain this framework. **END** 🐧

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